

Curriculum Vitæ - Vinicius Moris Placco

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Personal information

Full name Vinicius [v-knee-see-uh-s] Moris Placco
Languages Portuguese (native), English (fluent),
Spanish (intermediate), Italian (basic)

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Employment / Appointments

2024– US National Gemini Office Head – Community Science & Data Center
U.S. National Science Foundation National Optical-Infrared Astronomy Research Laboratory

2022– Associate Astronomer – Community Science & Data Center
U.S. National Science Foundation National Optical-Infrared Astronomy Research Laboratory

2023–2024 US National Gemini Office Acting Head – Community Science & Data Center
U.S. National Science Foundation National Optical-Infrared Astronomy Research Laboratory

2020–2022 Associate Scientist – Community Science & Data Center
U.S. National Science Foundation National Optical-Infrared Astronomy Research Laboratory

2015–2020 Research Assistant Professor – Department of Physics
University of Notre Dame

2018–2020 Faculty Fellow – Liu Institute for Asia and Asian Studies
University of Notre Dame

2014–2015 Science Fellow
Gemini Observatory – Northern Operations Center
Association of Universities for Research in Astronomy

2013–2014 Postdoctoral Fellow
National Optical Astronomy Observatory
Association of Universities for Research in Astronomy

2010–2013 Postdoctoral Fellow
Instituto de Astronomia, Geofísica e Ciências Atmosféricas
Universidade de São Paulo

2010–2011 External Consultant - Data Science and Statistics
Suzuki Veículos do Brasil S/A

2010–2010 Freelance Translator - Astronomy Brasil Magazine
Ediouro Duetto Editorial

Education

- 2007–2010 Doctorate degree in Astronomy
Search for very metal-poor stars based on carbon over-abundance
Instituto de Astronomia, Geofísica e Ciências Atmosféricas
Universidade de São Paulo
- 2005–2007 Master's degree in Astronomy
Abundance patterns among very metal-poor stars in the Galaxy: a statistical approach
Instituto de Astronomia, Geofísica e Ciências Atmosféricas
Universidade de São Paulo
- 2001–2005 Bachelor's degree in Physics (concentration: Astronomy)
Instituto de Física
Universidade de São Paulo

Awards

- 2024 *Outstanding Achievement Award – Science*
U.S. National Science Foundation National Optical-Infrared Astronomy Research Laboratory
Association of Universities for Research in Astronomy
- 2011 *Featured Astronomy thesis of the year 2010*
Instituto de Astronomia, Geofísica e Ciências Atmosféricas
Universidade de São Paulo
- 2005 *Best Astronomy undergraduate project*
Instituto de Astronomia, Geofísica e Ciências Atmosféricas
Universidade de São Paulo

Observatory Experience

Leadership roles/Service

- 2025–present US Member of the SOAR Telescope Board
- 2018–present Member of the J-PAS Survey Science Committee ([Javalambre Physics of the Accelerating Universe Survey](#))
- 2018–present Co-coordinator of the Resolved Stellar Population Working Group of the J-PAS Survey
- 2017–present Member of the S-PLUS Advisory Committee ([Southern Photometric Local Universe Survey](#))
- 2017–present Principal Investigator of the S-PLUS Short Survey
- 2017–2023 Subaru Telescope Proposal reviewer – category group: Normal Stars, Metal-Poor Stars
- 2018–2024 Member of the Maunakea Spectroscopic Explorer (MSE) [Science Team](#)
- 2020–2023 Hubble Space Telescope External Proposal reviewer
- 2019–2020 Member of the NSF NOIRLab Time Allocation Committee - [Galactic Panel 2](#)
- 2017–2020 US representative for the Gemini Observatory Users Committee
- 2018–2019 Member of the NOAO Time Allocation Committee - [Galactic Panel 2](#)
- 2017–2018 Member of the Gemini OCS Upgrades Working Group
- 2018 US Extremely Large Telescope Program – [First Stars Key Science Project](#)

Operations and Instrument/User Support

- 2020–present **NSF NOIRLab:** Community Science & Data Center – US National Gemini Office
 Product development for the Gemini user community:
 [Twitter account bots](#) – [daily completion](#), [weekly paper](#), [monthly completion](#), [other metrics](#)
 [GitHub repositories](#) – [DRAGONS Imaging tutorials](#), [IRAF Spectroscopy tutorials](#), [users dashboard](#)
 Co-organization of AAS Splinter Meetings
 Responsible for managing the [NOIRLab IRAF modernization project](#)
 Migration and maintenance of the [US NGO Portal](#)
 Migration and maintenance of the [GMOS Cookbook](#)
 Migration and maintenance of the [XDGNIRS Pipeline](#)
 Gemini HelpDesk – Responsible for selected Tiers 2 and 3 inquiries
- 2021–present **NSF NOIRLab:** Communications, Education & Engagement
 Supported the migration of the NOAO Science website to the new [NOIRLab Science website](#)
 Developed, revised, and curated content for the [NOIRLab Science website](#)
 Serve as a liaison between RSS and CEE
 Support science staff in adding/editing content on the science webpages
 Responding/routing science inquiries from usercomms@noirlab.edu and info@noirlab.edu
 Responsible for the curation of the [NOIRLab Capabilities Brochure](#)
- 2021–2022 **NSF NOIRLab:** Gemini Observatory – Science User Support Department
 Part of the Science Verification effort for the DRAGONS spectroscopic routines
 Early testing of the quick-look and interactive tools for DRAGONS
 Performance comparison between Gemini/IRAF and DRAGONS packages
- 2014–2015 **Gemini-North:** Operations
 Support Scientist for Phase II programs
 Backup support for instrument teams
 Interface between observatory and visitors (staff, scientists, and others)
 Interactions with astronomers, engineers, IT personnel, and facilities staff
 Community support (help-desk and troubleshooting)
 Write/edit/update internal and external webpages
 Weekly operations meetings
 Queue observer
 Data reductions

- 2014–2015 **Gemini-North:** GMOS Instrument Team
 Instrument performance monitoring pipeline
[Throughput characterization](#)
 Commissioning of AO capabilities
 Write/edit/update internal and external instrument webpages
 Data quality assessment
 Commissioning of Hamamatsu CCD at GMOS-S
- 2014–2015 **Gemini-North:** GRACES Instrument Team
 Commissioning of the instrument
 Developed early data-reduction pipeline
 Write/edit/update internal and external instrument webpages
 Developed exposure time calculator (GRACES ITC v0.1 Beta)
- 2008–2012 **SOAR Telescope:** remote observing station – University of São Paulo
 Responsible for operations and maintenance
 Develop data reduction tools
 Edit/write manuals and data analysis cookbooks
 User support and troubleshooting
 Configure, quote, and purchase new workstations and teleconference hardware
 Work with staff and IT personel to ensure access to buildings and computers
 Support daytime calibrations / nighttime observations

Observing Experience

Period	Telescope	# of nights	instrument	mode
2019–present	CTIO/Blanco	16	COSMOS	remote
2011–present	ESO/NTT	12	EFOSC2	visitor
2008–present	SOAR	40+	Goodman OSIRIS	remote
2013–2018	KPNO/Mayall	20+	RCSPEC KOSMOS	visitor/remote
2014–2015	Gemini North	12	GMOS GRACES GNIRS NIRI NIFS	queue observer
2014–2015	Gemini South	2	GMOS	remote
2013	McDonald 2.1m	4	ES2 Spectrometer	visitor

Research Experience

Funding

Current

2023–2026 Hubble Space Telescope (Co-I)
Fission of Transuranic Nuclei: A Potential Observational Signature in Metal-Poor Stars
 Space Telescope Science Institute (USD 2,873)

Past (Total: USD 475,229)

2025 International Research Network for Nuclear Astrophysics
The 2nd IReNA-Ukakuren Joint Workshop Advancing Nuclear Astrophysics and Beyond
 (USD 5,000 - Travel support for conference)

2020–2022 Hubble Space Telescope (Co-I)
Testing r-process nucleosynthesis models with two r-process enhanced stars
 Space Telescope Science Institute (USD 35,000)

2019–2021 Hubble Space Telescope (Co-PI)
HD 222925: A unique opportunity to study the full range of nuclei produced by a single r-process event
 Space Telescope Science Institute (USD 60,732)

2018–2020 Hubble Space Telescope (Co-PI)
The Unexplored Domains of the s-Process
 Space Telescope Science Institute (USD 119,104)

2018 Liu Institute for Asia & Asian Studies (PI)
Stellar Archaeology as a Time Machine to the First Stars
 University of Notre Dame (USD 600 - Travel support for conference)

2018 Liu Institute for Asia & Asian Studies (PI)
TDLI Workshop on The Exploding Universe
 University of Notre Dame (USD 2,600 - Travel support for conference)

2015–2017 Hubble Space Telescope (Co-I)
The First Detections of Phosphorus, Sulphur, and Zinc in a Bona-Fide Second-Generation Star
 Space Telescope Science Institute (USD 85,293)

2016–2017 Faculty Research Support Program Initiation Grant (PI)
Identification of CEMP Stars from S-PLUS Photometry using Artificial Neural Networks
 University of Notre Dame (USD 10,000)

2013–2014 FAPESP (State of São Paulo Research Foundation) – Postdoctorate
(re)discovery and analysis of metal-poor stars in the Milky Way
 National Optical Astronomy Observatory (USD 71,400)

2010–2013 FAPESP (State of São Paulo Research Foundation) – Postdoctorate
The Milky Way Halo revisited
 Universidade de São Paulo (USD 85,500)

Fellowships

- 2007–2010 Doctorate – FAPESP (07/04356-3) – Universidade de São Paulo
Search for very metal-poor stars based on carbon over-abundance
- 2005–2007 Master's – FAPESP (05/01023-8) – Universidade de São Paulo
Abundance patterns among very metal-poor stars in the Galaxy: a statistical approach
- 2004–2005 Undergraduate research project – CNPq/PIBIC – Universidade de São Paulo
Descoberta e Análise de Objetos com Linhas em Emissão no Survey HK
- 2002–2004 Undergraduate research project – FAPESP (02/04704-8) – Universidade de São Paulo
Construção de câmara de alvo gasoso para produção de feixes radioativos

Visiting Faculty/Postdoc/Graduate Student

- 2026/2023 Universidade de São Paulo
2022 Instituto de Astronomia, Geofísica e Ciências Atmosféricas
Funding: NOIRLab, USP/FAPESP (Brazil)
- 2020/2018 Universidade de São Paulo
Instituto de Astronomia, Geofísica e Ciências Atmosféricas
Funding: USP/FAPESP (Brazil), JINA-CEE
- 2018 Chungnam National University
Department of Astronomy & Space Science
Funding: CNU (Republic of Korea)
- 2014 University of Notre Dame
Department of Physics
Funding: Gemini Observatory and JINA (Joint Institute for Nuclear Astrophysics)
- 2014/2012 Massachusetts Institute of Technology
Kavli Institute for Astrophysics and Space Research
Funding: Gemini Observatory, FAPESP (The State of São Paulo Research Foundation – Brazil)
- 2013/2012 National Optical Astronomy Observatory
Kitt Peak National Observatory
Funding: FAPESP (Brazil)
- 2013 New Mexico State University
Department of Astronomy
Funding: FAPESP (Brazil)
- 2010/2008 Universität Heidelberg
Zentrum für Astronomie
Funding: Universität Heidelberg (Germany), FAPESP, PROEX (Brazil)
- 2010/2009 Michigan State University
2007 Physics and Astronomy Department
Funding: JINA (USA), FAPESP, PROEX (Brazil)

Telescope time allocations**Approved observing projects: 218****Total awarded: 7802.59 hours**

*does not include time allocated through university partnerships

Principal Investigator: 55**Total awarded: 1796.05 hours****Co Investigator: 163****Total awarded: 6006.54 hours**

Telescope	Proposals
GeminiSouth	87
GeminiNorth	38
SOAR	31
ESO/NTT	10
CTIO/Blanco	9
LCO/Magellan	6
SALT	5
KPNO/Mayall	5
McD/2.7m	4
ESO/VLT	4
NOT	3
LCO/duPont	3
McD/2.1m	2
LNA	2
HST	2
CFHT	2
APO	2
AAO/AAT	2
Subaru	1

Invited / Contributed Presentations

2026

- [112.](#) Escola Estadual Dom Pedro de Alcântara, Paraty
A Tabela Periódica Astrofísica
- [111.](#) S-PLUS 21st Collaboration Meeting
Why do we keep finding interesting stars with S-PLUS?
- [110.](#) Uppsala University – Astronomy and Space Physics Seminar
Stellar Genealogy: The Search for the First Stars and Everything in Between
- [109.](#) Stockholm University – Astronomy Seminar
Stellar Genealogy: The Search for the First Stars and Everything in Between
- [108.](#) Kitt Peak National Observatory – Docent in Training Program
The Study of Rainbows
- [107.](#) Universidade de São Paulo – Astronomy Department Research Update
HE 0144-4657: Finding what you are not looking for

2025

- [106.](#) Origin of Elements and Cosmic Evolution – Workshop
Neutron-capture in the wild: Finding R-Process Enhanced Metal-Poor Stars in the Milky Way
- [105.](#) Origin of Elements and Cosmic Evolution – Pre-Workshop School
Stellar Genealogy: Metal-Poor Stars as Probes of the Chemical Evolution of the Universe
- [104.](#) Kartchner Caverns State Park – Discovery Center Science Talk
A tale of two stars: Revealing the Age and Chemical Evolution of the Universe
- [103.](#) Kitt Peak National Observatory – Kitt Peak Visitor Center Docent Meeting
Astronomer by Accident: How Serendipity and Diligence Can Shape a Career
- [102.](#) S-PLUS Collaboration – Bi-weekly Science Seminar Series
The DECam MAGIC Survey: Spectroscopic Follow-up of the Most Metal-poor Stars in the Distant Milky Way Halo – Going on an Informed Fishing Expedition
- [101.](#) Kitt Peak National Observatory – Docent in Training Program
Spectroscopy for people in a hurry
- [100.](#) The 2nd IReNA-Ukakuren Joint Workshop “Advancing Nuclear Astrophysics and Beyond”
Neutron-capture in the wild: finding r-process enhanced metal-poor stars in the Milky Way
- [99.](#) AAS 246 - Stars, Cool Dwarfs, Brown Dwarfs Session
Finding Extremely and Ultra Metal-Poor Stars using Narrowband Photometry from the MAGIC Survey
- [98.](#) Kavli Institute for Cosmological Physics | The University of Chicago - Open Group Seminars
BD+44° 493: Where Near Field Cosmology Meets Exoplanet Science
- [97.](#) WIYN Board Meeting – Lunch Science Presentation
BD+44° 493: Chemo-Dynamics and Constraints on Companion Planetary Masses from WIYN/NEID Spectroscopy
- [96.](#) Huachuca Astronomy Club – Monthly Science Presentation
A tale of two stars: Revealing the Age and Chemical Evolution of the Universe
- [95.](#) Kitt Peak National Observatory – Docent in Training Program
Spectroscopy (a.k.a. the study of rainbows)
- [94.](#) AAS 245 - A conversation about the Gemini Observatory Strategic Plan for the 2030s
GHOST Reduced Data Products for the Gemini Observatory Community and Beyond
- [93.](#) National Astronomical Observatory of Japan - Science Colloquium
Stellar Genealogy: Rare Gems in the Milky Way as Probes of the Chemical Evolution of the Universe

2024

- [92.](#) NSF NOIRLab – Users Committee for NOIRLab (UCN)
Aspects of Data Reduction Support at NOIRLab
- [91.](#) Kitt Peak National Observatory – Docent in Training Program
Spectroscopy for People in a Hurry
- 90. Nuclear Physics in Astrophysics XI
Neutron-capture in the wild: finding r-process enhanced metal-poor stars in the Milky Way and beyond
- [89.](#) Rare Gems in Big Data
Stellar Genealogy: Rare Gems in the Milky Way as Probes of the Chemical Evolution of the Universe
- [88.](#) Kitt Peak National Observatory – Docent in Training Program
Spectroscopy (a.k.a. the study of rainbows)

2023

- 87. DELVE Collaboration Meeting
How to also find what you are not looking for: going on a fishing expedition
- 86. XIX J-PAS Collaboration Meeting
An R-process Enhanced Extremely Metal-Poor Star Identified with Narrow-band Photometry
- [85.](#) International Research Network for Nuclear Astrophysics – Online Seminar Series (watch it on Youtube)
Neutron-capture in the wild: finding r-process enhanced metal-poor stars in the Milky Way and beyond
- 84. Observatório Nacional – S-PLUS 18th Collaboration Meeting
An r-process enhanced extremely metal-poor star identified by S-PLUS
- [83.](#) NSF's NOIRLab – NOIRLab South Colloquium
What else can you find when looking for Carbon Enhanced Ultra Metal-Poor Stars? A GHOST Story
- 82. NSF's NOIRLab – GHOST Webinar Series
How to Find What You Are Not Looking For: The curious case of SPLUS J1424-2542
- [81.](#) Lund University
What else can you find when looking for Ultra Metal-Poor Stars?
- 80. NSF's NOIRLab – SWEETS (Support Work Education and Exchange Talk Series)
The US National Gemini Office

2022

- 79. Centro de Estudios de Física del Cosmos de Aragón – 18th J-PAS Collaboration Meeting
The miniJPAS survey: stellar atmospheric parameters from 56 optical filters
- 78. NSF's NOIRLab – DECam at 10 years - Looking Back, Looking Forward
Searching for Chemically Pristine Stars with Narrowband Photometry
- 77. Centro Brasileiro de Pesquisas Físicas – S-PLUS 17th Collaboration Meeting
Mining S-PLUS for Metal-Poor Stars in the Milky Way
- [76.](#) Planetário da Gávea, Rio de Janeiro – O Céu do Sul e suas Maravilhas
SPLUS J2104–0049 e a Evolução Química do Universo
- [75.](#) Universidade de São Paulo – Astronomia ao Meio-dia (watch it on Youtube – in Portuguese)
A Tabela Periódica Astrofísica
- [74.](#) Universidade de São Paulo – Astrophysics Colloquium (watch it on Youtube)
Is Carbon Ubiquitous in the High-Redshift Universe? A Stellar Archaeology perspective
- 73. Gemini Observatory Science Meeting 2022
Making good use of bad weather: a chemically pristine star found through the clouds with Gemini

- [72.](#) Observatório Nacional – [Seminário da Coordenação de Astronomia e Astrofísica](#)
Stellar Archaeology and Near-Field Cosmology: Understanding the Chemical Evolution of the Universe

2021

- [71.](#) Universidade de São Paulo – [S-PLUS 16th Collaboration Meeting](#)
Mining the S-PLUS catalog to find chemically peculiar stars in the Galaxy
- [70.](#) Instituto Nacional de Pesquisas Espaciais – [Seminários da Divisão de Astrofísica](#) (watch it on [Youtube](#))
Stellar Archaeology and Near-Field Cosmology: Understanding the Chemical Evolution of the Universe
- [69.](#) Universidade Federal de Santa Catarina – [IX Encontro de Física e Astronomia da UFSC](#)
Stellar Archaeology and Near-Field Cosmology: Understanding the Chemical Evolution of the Universe
- [68.](#) Joint Institute for Nuclear Astrophysics – [Physics of Atomic Nuclei High School Program](#)
The Age and Chemical Evolution of the Universe from Two Stars in the Milky Way
- [67.](#) Universidade de São Paulo – [S-PLUS 15th Collaboration Meeting](#)
Searching for low-metallicity stars in S-PLUS
- [66.](#) NSF's NOIRLab – [Live from NOIRLab @ Hawai'i](#) (watch it on [Youtube](#))
A chemically-peculiar star found from its colors

2020

- [65.](#) NSF's NOIRLab – [Live from NOIRLab @ Hawai'i](#) ([Youtube](#))
The Age and Chemical Evolution of the Universe from Two Stars in the Milky Way
- [64.](#) NSF's NOIRLab – Gemini Observatory Science Coffee
From $R=40$ to $R=40,000$: Mining narrow-band photometric catalogs in search of low-metallicity stars
- [63.](#) Joint Institute for Nuclear Astrophysics – [Physics of Atomic Nuclei High School Program](#)
The Age and Chemical Evolution of the Universe from Two Stars in the Milky Way
- [62.](#) [Regional Center for Space Science and Tec Education for West Asia / Arab Union for Astronomy & Space Science](#)
Our eyes in the skies: How telescopes help us place ourselves in the Universe
- [61.](#) NSF's NOIRLab Colloquium
Near-Field Cosmology with Narrow-Band Photometry and Spectroscopy of Low-Metallicity Stars
- [60.](#) Universidade de São Paulo – [Astrophysics Colloquium](#)
Near-Field Cosmology using Narrow-Band Photometry and Low-Metallicity Stars
- [59.](#) Universidade de São Paulo – [Astronomia ao Meio-dia](#) (watch it on [Youtube](#) – in Portuguese)
Agulhas no palheiro: A evolução química e idade do Universo contadas por duas estrelas

2019

- [58.](#) National Optical Astronomy Observatory
Stellar Archaeology: Understanding the Chemical Evolution of the Universe through Color Maps of the Night Sky
- [57.](#) Joint Institute for Nuclear Astrophysics – [Physics of Atomic Nuclei High School Program](#)
The Age and Chemical Evolution of the Universe from two stars in the Milky Way
- [56.](#) Consejo Superior de Investigaciones Científicas – [17th J-PAS Collaboration Meeting](#)
Identification of Low-Metallicity Stars from Narrow-Band Photometry
- [55.](#) San Francisco State University – [Physics & Astronomy Colloquium](#)
Stellar Archaeology: Origin of the Chemical Elements in the Universe through a 59-Color Map of the Sky

2018

- [54.](#) Kavli IPMU at The University of Tokyo – [Stellar Archaeology as a Time Machine to the First Stars](#)
The Mass Distribution of the First Stars revealed by Abundance Pattern Matching of Ultra Metal-Poor Stars
- 53. Kavli IPMU at The University of Tokyo – [Introduction to Stellar Archaeology](#)
Radioactive Stellar Ages
- [52.](#) Texas A&M University Commerce – Physics & Astronomy Colloquium
Stellar Archaeology: Understanding the Origin of the Chemical Elements through a 59-Color Map of the Night Sky
- [51.](#) Chungnam National University – Department of Astronomy & Space Science [Seminar](#)
The Origin of the Chemical Elements in the Universe revealed by a 12-Color Map of the Night Sky
- [50.](#) Korea Astronomy and Space Science Institute [Colloquium](#)
Constraints on Near-Field Cosmology through Abundance Pattern Matching of Ultra Metal-Poor Stars
- [49.](#) Universidade de São Paulo – [Astronomy Colloquium](#)
The Southern Photometric Local Universe Survey (S-PLUS): An Overview
- 48. Universidade de São Paulo – [S-PLUS Meeting](#)
Short update on S-PLUS SHORTS
- 47. University of Notre Dame – Astronomy 1-minute talks (23 presenters)
Organizer and Presenter
- [46.](#) University of Notre Dame – [Our Universe Revealed](#)
A day in the life of an Astronomer
- 45. Kavli Institute for Cosmological Physics – [Near-Field Cosmology with the Dark Energy Survey](#)
The Age Structure of the Milky Way Halo revealed by DES
- [44.](#) Joint Institute for Nuclear Astrophysics – [Physics of Atomic Nuclei High School Program](#)
Can we talk about the Age and Chemical Evolution of the Universe by looking at only two stars?
- 43. Centro de Estudios de Física del Cosmos de Aragón – J-PLUS 2nd Virtual Meeting
J-PLUS Stellar Parameter Value Added Catalog
- [42.](#) Shanghai Jiao Tong University – Tsung-Dao Lee Institute [Workshop on The Exploding Universe](#)
Probing the mass distribution of the first stars through abundance pattern matching of ultra metal-poor stars
- [41.](#) JINA-CEE Frontiers in Nuclear Astrophysics – [Main Conference](#)
Observational constraints on the origin of the elements: from First stars to Neutron-Star mergers
- [40.](#) Manhattan College – Physics Department Colloquium
Understanding the Origin of the Elements in the Universe through a 12-Color Map of the Night Sky
- [39.](#) JINA-CEE Frontiers in Nuclear Astrophysics – [Junior Workshop](#)
Speaking Skills
- [38.](#) Centro de Estudios de Física del Cosmos de Aragón – [16th J-PAS Collaboration Meeting - Pathfinder science](#)
Constraints on First-Star Nucleosynthesis from J-PAS Photometry of Low-Metallicity Stars
- 37. Universidade de São Paulo – S-PLUS Collaboration Meeting (online)
Updates on S-PLUS Short Survey(s)

2017

- 36. Universidade de São Paulo – S-PLUS Collaboration Meeting (online)
Updates on S-PLUS Short Survey(s)
- [35.](#) Michiana Astronomical Society – [MAS monthly meeting speaker](#)
A Tale of Two Stars: Revealing the Age and Chemical Evolution of the Universe
- 34. University of Notre Dame – Astro-Skills Lunch
The do's and don'ts when plotting data

33. Red de Infraestructuras de Astronomía – [Early Data Release and Scientific Exploitation of the J-PLUS Survey](#)
[Identification of \(Bright\) Carbon-Enhanced Metal-Poor Stars with J-PLUS Photometry](#)
32. GMT Community Science Meeting – Chemical Evolution of the Universe
[A Monte Carlo approach to find the Progenitors of Ultra Metal-Poor Stars](#) (Rapid Poster Talk)
31. University of Notre Dame – [The Great American Eclipse at Notre Dame](#)
Co-organizer / Astronomy faculty representative – 3,500 attendees
- [30.](#) University of Notre Dame – Research Experiences for Undergraduates (REU) Program
[A needle in a haystack: What one star can tell us about the age and chemical evolution of the entire Universe](#)
29. Centro de Estudios de Física del Cosmos de Aragón – J-PLUS 1st Virtual Meeting
[Identifying \(Carbon-Enhanced\) Metal-Poor Stars from J-PLUS Photometry](#)
- [28.](#) Joint Institute for Nuclear Astrophysics – [Physics of Atomic Nuclei High School Program](#)
[Stellar Archaeology: The Age and Chemistry of the Universe revealed by old Stars](#)
- [27.](#) Universidade de São Paulo – [Astrophysics Colloquium](#)
[Searching for the Origin of the Elements Using a 12-Color Map of the Night Sky](#)

2016

- [26.](#) University of Notre Dame – [Astrophysics Seminar](#)
[A Monte Carlo approach to find the Progenitors of Ultra Metal-Poor Stars](#)
- [25.](#) University of Notre Dame – [Department of Physics Colloquium](#)
[Searching for the Origin of the Elements Using a 12-Color Map of the Night Sky](#)
24. University of Notre Dame – Astronomy 1-minute talks (19 presenters)
Organizer and Presenter
23. Universidade de São Paulo – X-PLUS Collaboration Meeting
[Identifying Bright Carbon-Enhanced Metal-Poor Stars from S-PLUS Photometry](#)
- [22.](#) University of Notre Dame – Research Experiences for Undergraduates (REU) Program
[Near-Field Cosmology with Metal-Poor Stars](#)
- [21.](#) University of Notre Dame – [Our Universe Revealed](#)
A day in the life of an Astronomer
20. University of Notre Dame – [Our Universe Revealed](#)
Our eyes in the skies: How telescopes help us place ourselves in the Universe
19. 227th Meeting of the American Astronomical Society
[Identifying Bright Carbon-Enhanced Metal-Poor Stars in the RAVE Catalog](#)

2015

18. University of Notre Dame – [Our Universe Revealed](#)
[The stuff we are made of: how do we determine the chemical elements in stars and the Universe?](#)
17. University of Notre Dame – Astronomy 1-minute talks (15 presenters)
Organizer and Presenter
- [16.](#) Joint Institute for Nuclear Astrophysics / University of Notre Dame – High School On Air Talk
[Stellar Archaeology: The Age and Chemistry of the Universe revealed by old Stars – YouTube video](#)
- [15.](#) Michigan State University – JINA-CEE Nuclear Astrophysics Lunch Research Discussions
[Observing the First Stars through the Atmospheres of Ultra Metal-Poor Stars](#)
14. Universidade de São Paulo – X-PLUS Collaboration Meeting
[Identifying Carbon-Enhanced Metal-Poor Stars from S-PLUS Photometry](#)
- [13.](#) University of Notre Dame – Research Experiences for Undergraduates (REU) Program
[Galactic Archaeology: The Chemical Evolution and Age of the Universe revealed by old Stars](#)

2014

- [12.](#) University of Notre Dame – [Astronomy Seminar](#)
Exploring the history of the Galactic halo with Carbon-Enhanced Metal-Poor stars
- [11.](#) Massachusetts Institute of Technology – Kavli Institute
Exploring the history of the Galactic halo with Carbon-Enhanced Metal-Poor stars

2013

- 10. National Optical Astronomy Observatory
(Carbon Enhanced) metal-poor stars and the chemical evolution of the Universe
- [9.](#) Gemini Observatory – Northern Operations Center
Metal-poor stars as tracers of the chemical evolution of the Galaxy

2012

- [8.](#) Universidade Cruzeiro do Sul - Astronomy Colloquium
Search for Carbon-Enhanced Metal-Poor stars in the Halo(es) of the Galaxy
- [7.](#) Universidade de São Paulo - Astronomy Colloquium
Spectroscopy from $R=300$ to 30000: metal-poor stars and Galactic chemical evolution
- [6.](#) Universidade de São Paulo - Invitation to Physics: undergraduate weekly seminar
Arqueologia Galáctica: a evolução química do universo revelada por estrelas pobres em metais
- 5. Universidade de São Paulo - Astronomy at noon: undergraduate weekly seminar
Census of the Milky Way

2011

- 4. Universidade de São Paulo - Chemical Evolution Group Seminar
Rediscovering the Dual Halo of the Milky Way via Hierarchical Clustering
- 3. Universidade de São Paulo - Astronomy at noon: undergraduate weekly seminar
Stellar Archaeology
- 2. Universidade de São Paulo - Astronomy Colloquium
Making good use of bad weather: finding extremely metal-poor stars in the clouds
- [1.](#) ESO Headquarters - Santiago - Astronomy Colloquium
Searches for Metal-Poor Stars from the Hamburg/ESO Survey using the CH G-band

Academic Experience

Student/Postdoc supervision

Postdoctoral level

2022–2023 Felipe de Almeida Fernandes ([Universidade de São Paulo](#) - Visiting Fellow at NSF NOIRLab)

Graduate Level

2025– Debasish Hazarika (University of Atacama, Chile - Visiting Student at NSF NOIRLab)
2023–2024 Eduardo Machado Pereira (Observatório Nacional, Brazil - Visiting Student at NSF NOIRLab)
2019–2022 Carlos Andrés Galarza Arevalo ([Observatório Nacional - Brazil](#))
2019–2022 Joseph Zepeda (University of Notre Dame)
2019–2022 Derek Shank (University of Notre Dame)
2015–2020 Sarah Dietz (University of Notre Dame)
2015–2020 Dmitrii Gudín (University of Notre Dame)
2015–2020 Devin Whitten (University of Notre Dame)
2015–2020 Kaitlin Rasmussen (University of Notre Dame)
2015–2017 Geoffrey Lentner (University of Notre Dame)
2010–2016 Rafael Santucci (M.Sc. and Ph.D. - Universidade de São Paulo)

Undergraduate Level - University of Notre Dame

2020 Dante Komater (Physics Major)
2019–2020 Lucas Pinheiro (Engineering Major)
2019 Shenghua Liu (Physics Major)
2019 Winter Allen (Arkansas Tech University - REU)
2019 Yihao Zhou (Shanghai Jiao Tong University - REU)
2016–2018 Erik Peterson
2016–2018 David Kalamarides
2015–2018 Spencer Clark (Glynn Family Honors Program) - [Senior Thesis](#)
2016–2017 John Roach
2016–2017 Cristobal Gonzales
2016–2017 Michael Kurkowski
2017 Jazmine Jefferson (University of Kansas - REU)
2017 Derek Shank (Ohio Wesleyan University - DISC/REU) - [video report](#)
2017 Diego Fernandez (University of Oregon - REU)
2016 Travis Hodges (Austin Peay State University - DISC/REU)
2016 Miguel Correa (San Diego State University - REU)
2015 Siyu He (Xi'an Jiaotong University - REU)
2012–2014 William Alves (Universidade de São Paulo)
2008–2010 Rafael Santucci (Universidade de São Paulo)

Committee Service - University of Notre Dame

- 2019–2020 Undergraduate Research, Department of Physics
- 2016–2018 Graduate Recruitment, Department of Physics
- 2015–2018 Preliminary Exam Committee, Department of Physics
- 2015–2018 University Committee on Research & Sponsored Programs, Notre Dame Research

Thesis Defense Committee

- 2025 [Eduardo Machado Pereira](#) (Ph.D.)
Observatório Nacional
- 2024 [Paulo Cesar Vargas Junior](#) (M.Sc.)
Universidade Federal de Goiás
- 2024 [Guilherme Limberg](#) (Ph.D.)
Universidade de São Paulo
- 2024 [Franklin T. S. Sampaio](#) (M.Sc.)
Universidade Federal de Goiás
- 2024 [Fábio Carneiro Wanderley](#) (Ph.D.)
Observatório Nacional
- 2024 [Elvis William Carvalho Cantelli](#) (Ph.D.)
Universidade de São Paulo
- 2023 [Yuri Abuchaim de Oliveira](#) (M.Sc.)
Universidade de São Paulo
- 2023 [Fabricia Oliveira Barbosa](#) (M.Sc.)
Universidade de São Paulo
- 2018–2022 [Heitor Ernandes](#) (Ph.D. - committee chair)
Universidade de São Paulo
- 2021 [Raphaela Fernandes de Melo](#) (M.Sc.)
Observatório Nacional
- 2019 [Henrique Reggiani](#) (Ph.D.)
Universidade de São Paulo
- 2016 [Rafael Miloni Santucci](#) (Ph.D.)
Universidade de São Paulo
- 2016 [Camilo Francisco Javier Muñoz Peña](#) (M.Sc.)
Universidade de São Paulo

Organizing Committee - Conferences and Workshops

- 2024 [Rare Gems in Big Data](#)
NSF NOIRLab
- 2022 [DECam at 10 years - Looking Back, Looking Forward](#)
NSF NOIRLab

Teaching

Lead Instructor (LI) / Co-Instructor (CI) / Guest Lecturer (GL)

Undergraduate

University of Notre Dame

- | | | |
|------|------|--|
| 2020 | (LI) | Descriptive Astronomy (SU20-PHYS-10140)
Course Instructor Feedback: 5.0/5.0 - link to full report |
| | (LI) | Descriptive Astronomy (SP20-PHYS-10140)
Course Instructor Feedback: 5.0/5.0 - link to full report |
| | (LI) | General Physics B - E & M Laboratory (SP20-PHYS-11422)
Course Instructor Feedback: 5.0/5.0 - link to full report |
| | (GL) | Engineering Physics II Laboratory (SP20-PHYS-11320) |
| | (GL) | Engineering Physics I Laboratory (SP20-PHYS-11310) |
| 2019 | (LI) | Physics A - Mechanics Laboratory (FA19-PHYS-11411)
Course Instructor Feedback: 5.0/5.0 - link to full report |
| | (LI) | Descriptive Astronomy (SU19-PHYS-10140)
Course Instructor Feedback: 5.0/5.0 - link to full report |
| 2018 | (GL) | Descriptive Astronomy (FA18-PHYS-10140) |
| 2017 | (CI) | Descriptive Astronomy (FA17-PHYS-10140) |
| | (LI) | General Physics B - E & M Laboratory (SP17-PHYS-11422)
Course Instructor Feedback: 4.8/5.0 - link to full report |
| 2016 | (GL) | Descriptive Astronomy (FA16-PHYS-10140) |
| 2015 | (GL) | Modern Observational Techniques (FA15-PHYS-30481) |

Universidade Virtual do Estado de São Paulo

- | | | |
|------|------|--------------------------------|
| 2012 | (LI) | Sky and Stars: An introduction |
| | (LI) | Galaxies: An introduction |
| 2011 | (LI) | Sky and Stars: An introduction |
| | (LI) | Galaxies: An introduction |

Graduate

University of Notre Dame

- | | | |
|------|------|--|
| 2017 | (CI) | Astrophysics: Stars (SP17-PHYS-80202) |
| 2016 | (CI) | Large-Scale Astronomical Surveys (SP16-PHYS-70210) |
| 2015 | (GL) | Astrophysics: Stars (SP15-PHYS-80202) |

Universidade de São Paulo

- | | | |
|------|------|-------------------------|
| 2012 | (GL) | Observational Astronomy |
|------|------|-------------------------|

Teaching Assistant - Universidade de São Paulo

- | | |
|------|---------------------------|
| 2009 | Introduction to Astronomy |
| | Fundamental Astronomy |
| 2008 | Introduction to Astronomy |
| 2007 | Fundamental Astronomy |

Other relevant information

Technical skills

Linux/Unix/MACOSX/Windows operating systems
Shell Scripting (sh, bash, tcsh, zsh)
L^AT_EX, OpenOffice, MS Office. Co-author of the L^AT_EXtemplate [IAGTESE](#)
Python (iPython/Jupyter Notebooks): scipy, numpy, pandas, scikitlearn, pyfits, astropy
R-project (terminal/RStudio): FITSio, tidyverse, cluster, sciviews
Databases: SQL (PostgreSQL/pgAdmin3), SDSS CasJobs, ADQL (J-PLUS/J-PAS/TAPVizieR)
Web: html, ccs, wordpress, apache, curl, wget, ssh, ftp, drupal, Google Analytics, Matomo
Graphics: Gnuplot, ggplot2, matplotlib, bokeh, tableau
Data reduction: IRAF/Pyraf packages, DRAGONS, ESO Reflex/Gasgano
Astronomy tools: WCSTools, CDSclient, STILTS, SkyCalc
Documentation: Sphinx, readthedocs
Version control and DevOps: Git, GitHub, GitLab

Online Resources

Webpage: <http://vmplacco.github.io/>
LinkedIn: <https://www.linkedin.com/in/vinicius-placco/>
GitHub: <https://github.com/vmplacco/>
stackoverflow: <https://stackoverflow.com/users/5964833/vinicius-placco>
pythonanywhere: <https://vplacco.pythonanywhere.com/>
Sample webpages/
side projects: <http://vmplacco.github.io/#resources>

Professional Affiliations/Service

Member of the American Astronomical Society
Member of the Brazilian Astronomical Society
Member of the Brazilian Physical Society
Member of the JINA Center for the Evolution of the Elements

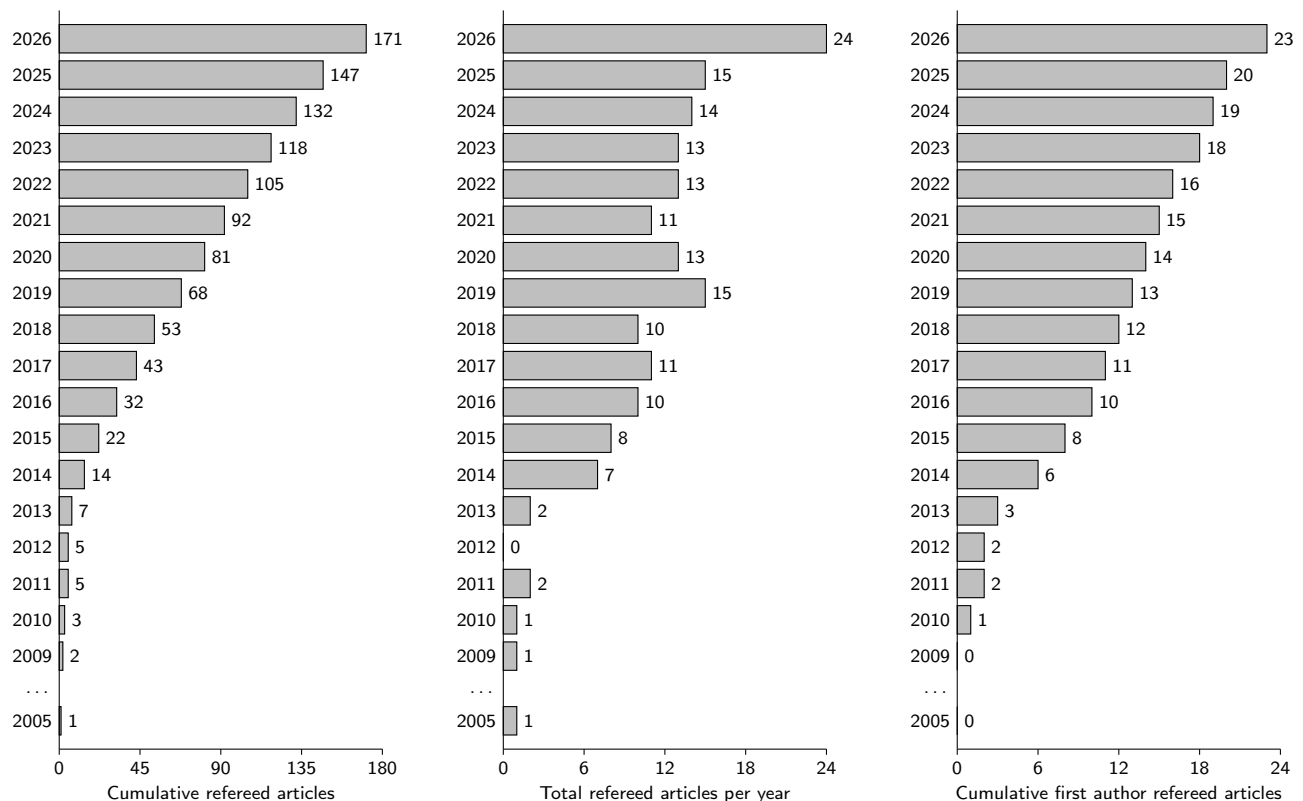
Referee for The Astronomy and Astrophysics Review
Referee for the American Astronomical Society Journals
Referee for the AAAS Science Magazine
Referee for Astronomy & Astrophysics
Referee for Monthly Notices of the Royal Astronomical Society
Referee for Astronomy & Computing

Quantitative Indicators

- astrophysics data system (September 17, 2026 - [ADS link](#))
 - **12228 citations (1305 as first author)**
 - **h-index = 51 (19 as first author)**
 - **i10-index = 135 (20 as first author)**
- Google Scholar (September 17, 2026 - [Google Scholar link](#))
 - **15221 citations**
 - **h-index = 56**
 - **i10-index = 130**
- ADS Publication Lists
 - Complete - [ADS link](#)
 - Refereed only - [ADS link](#)
- ORCID iD - [0000-0003-4479-1265](#)

Publication List - Refereed Articles

Total: 171 publications (including 23 first, 16 second, and 20 third author articles)



First Author (* for relevant non-refereed publications)

- [23.](#) **Placco, V. M.**, Rodrigues de Lima, E. V., Mendes de Oliveira, C. L., et al.
S-PLUS in the 4MOST Era: From Metal-Poor Stars to Galaxy Clusters
2026, **The Astronomical Journal**, submitted
- [22.](#) **Placco, V. M.** & Vacca, W. D.
Near-Infrared Observations of BD+44° 493 with IGRINS-2
2026, **The Astronomical Journal**, vol. 172, 142 ([ADS](#))
- [21.](#) **Placco, V. M.**, Limberg, G., Kennedy, C., Christlieb, N.
HE 0144–4657: A Carbon-Enhanced Ultra Metal-Poor Star ($[Fe/H] \sim -4.1$) from the Helmi Stream Disrupted Dwarf Galaxy
2026, **The Astrophysical Journal Letters**, vol. 1000, L34 ([ADS](#))
- [20.](#) **Placco, V. M.**, Limberg, G., Chiti, A., Prabhu, D. S., Ji, A. P., Barbosa, F. O., Cerny, W., Pace, A. B., Stringfellow, G. S., Sand, D. J., Martínez-Vázquez, C. E., Riley, A. H., Rossi, S., Noël, N. E. D., Vivas, A. K., Medina, G. E., Drlica-Wagner, A., Sakowska, J. D., Mutlu-Pakdil, B., Massana, P., Carballo-Bello, J. A., Choi, Y., Crnojević, D., Tan, C. Y.
The DECam MAGIC Survey: Spectroscopic Follow-up of the Most Metal-Poor Stars in the Distant MW Halo
2025, **The Astrophysical Journal**, vol. 991, 101 ([ADS](#))
- [19.](#) **Placco, V. M.**, Gupta, A. F., Almeida-Fernandes, F., Logsdon, S. E., Rajagopal, J., Holmbeck, E. M., Roederer, I. U., Della Costa, J., Fernandez, P., Golub, E., Higuera, J., Patel, Y., Ridgway, S., Schweiker, H.
BD+44° 493: Chemo-Dynamical Analysis and Constraints on Companion Planetary Masses from WIYN/NEID Spectroscopy
2024, **The Astrophysical Journal**, vol. 977, 12 ([ADS](#))
- * **Placco, V. M.**, Herrera, D., Merino, B. M., Hirst, P., Labrie, K., Simpson, C., Turner, J., Vacca, W. D., Deibert, E., Diaz, R., Heo, J., Kalari, V., Reggiani, H., Rodriguez, C., Ruiz-Carmona, R., Thomas-Osip, J.
GHOST Reduced Data Products for the Gemini Observatory Community and Beyond
2024, **Research Notes of the American Astronomical Society**, vol. 8, 12 ([ADS](#))
- [18.](#) **Placco, V. M.**, Almeida-Fernandes, F., Holmbeck, E. M., Roederer, I. U., Mardini, M. K., Hayes, C. R., Venn, K., Chiboucas, K., Deibert, E., Gamen, R., Heo, J., Jeong, M., Kalari, V., Martioli, E., Xu, S., Diaz, R., Gomez-Jimenez, M., Henderson, D., Prado, P., Quiroz, C., Ruiz-Carmona, R., Simpson, C., Urrutia, C., McConnachie, A. W., Pazder, J., Burley, G., Ireland, M., Waller, F., Berg, T. A. M., Robertson, J. G., Hartman, Z., Jones, D. O., Labrie, K., Perez, G., Ridgway, S., Thomas-Osip, J.
SPLUS J142445.34–254247.1: An R-Process Enhanced, Actinide-Boost, Extremely Metal-Poor star observed with GHOST
2023, **The Astrophysical Journal**, vol. 959, 60 ([ADS](#))
- [17.](#) **Placco, V. M.** & Stanghellini, L.
US National Gemini Office in the NOIRLab era
2023, **Journal of Astronomical Telescopes, Instruments, and Systems**, vol. 9, 7003 ([ADS](#))
- [16.](#) **Placco, V. M.**, Almeida-Fernandes, F., Arentsen, A., Lee, Y. S., Schoenell, W., Ribeiro, T., Kanaan, A.
Mining S-PLUS for Metal-Poor Stars in the Milky Way
2022, **The Astrophysical Journal Supplement Series**, vol. 262, 8 ([ADS](#))
- [15.](#) **Placco, V. M.**, Roederer, I. U., Lee, Y. S., Almeida-Fernandes, F., Herpich, F. R., Perottoni, H. D., Schoenell, W., Ribeiro, T., Kanaan, A.
SPLUS J210428.01–004934.2: An Ultra Metal-Poor Star Identified from Narrow-Band Photometry
2021, **The Astrophysical Journal Letters**, vol. 912, 32 ([ADS](#))
- * **Placco, V. M.**, Sneden, C., Roederer, I. U., Lawler, J. E., Den Hartog, E. A., Hejazi, N., Maas, Z., Bernath, P.
linemake: an Atomic and Molecular Line List Generator
2021, **Research Notes of the American Astronomical Society**, vol. 5, 92 ([ADS](#) | [PDF](#))

- 14. Placco, V. M.**, Santucci, R. M., Yuan, Z., Mardini, M. K., Holmbeck, E. M., Wang, X., Surman, R., Hansen, T., Roederer, I. U., Beers, T., Choplin, A., Ji, A., Ezzeddine, R., Frebel, A., Sakari, C., Whitten, D., Zepeda, J.
The R-Process Alliance: The Peculiar Chemical Abundance Pattern of RAVE J183013.5–455510
2020, *The Astrophysical Journal*, vol. 897, 78 ([ADS](#))
- 13. Placco, V. M.**, Santucci, R. M., Beers, T. C., Chanamé, J., Sepúlveda, M. P., Coronado, J., Rossi, S., Lee, Y. S., Starkenburg, E., Youakim, K., Barrientos, M., Ezzeddine, R., Frebel, A., Hansen, T. T., Holmbeck, E. M., Ji, A. P., Rasmussen, K. C., Roederer, I. U., Sakari, C. M., Whitten, D. D.
The R-Process Alliance: Spectroscopic Follow-up of 857 Low-Metallicity Star Candidates from the Best & Brightest Survey
2019, *The Astrophysical Journal*, vol. 870, 122 ([ADS](#))
- 12. Placco, V. M.**, Beers, T. C., Santucci, R. M., Chanamé, J., Sepúlveda, M. P., Coronado, J., Points, S. D., Kaleida, C. C., Rossi, S., Kordopatis, G., Lee, Y. S., Matijević, G., Frebel, A., Hansen, T. T., Holmbeck, E. M., Rasmussen, K. C., Roederer, I. U., Sakari, C. M., Whitten, D. D.
Spectroscopic Validation of Low-Metallicity Stars from RAVE
2018, *The Astronomical Journal*, vol. 155, 256 ([ADS](#))
- 11. Placco, V. M.**, Holmbeck, E. M., Frebel, A., Beers, T. C., Surman, R. A., Ji, A. P., Ezzeddine, R., Points, S. D., Kaleida, C. C., Hansen, T. T., Sakari, C. M., Casey, A. R.
RAVE J203843.2–002333: The First Highly R-process-enhanced Star Identified in the RAVE Survey.
2017, *The Astrophysical Journal*, vol. 844, 18 ([ADS](#))
- 10. Placco, V. M.**, Frebel, A., Beers, T. C., Yoon, J., Chiti, A., Heger, A. Chan, C., Casey, A. R., Christlieb, N.
Observational Constraints on First-Star Nucleosynthesis. II. Spectroscopy of an Ultra Metal-Poor CEMP-no Star
2016, *The Astrophysical Journal*, vol. 833, 21 ([ADS](#))
- 9. Placco, V. M.**, Beers, T. C., Reggiani, H., Meléndez, J.
G64–12 and G64–37 are Carbon-Enhanced Metal-Poor Stars
2016, *The Astrophysical Journal Letters*, vol. 829, 24 ([ADS](#))
- 8. Placco, V. M.**, Beers, T. C., Ivans, I. I., Filler, D., Imig, J. A., Roederer, I., Abate, C., Hansen, T., Cowan, J., Frebel, A., Lawler, J. E., Schatz, H., Sneden, C., Sobek, J., Aoki, W., Smith, V. V., Bolte, M.
Hubble Space Telescope Near-Ultraviolet Spectroscopy of the Bright CEMP-s Stars
2015, *The Astrophysical Journal*, vol. 812, 109 ([ADS](#))
- 7. Placco, V. M.**, Frebel, A., Lee, Y. S., Jacobson, H. R., Beers, T. C., Pena, J. M., Chan, C., Heger, A.
Metal-poor Stars Observed with the Magellan Telescope. III. New Extremely and Ultra Metal-Poor Stars from SDSS/SEGUE and Insights on the Formation of Ultra Metal-Poor Stars
2015, *The Astrophysical Journal*, vol. 809, 136 ([ADS](#))
- 6. Placco, V. M.**, Beers, T. C., Frebel, A., Stancliffe R.
Carbon-Enhanced Metal-Poor Star Frequencies in the Galaxy: Corrections for the Effect of Evolutionary Status on Carbon Abundances
2014, *The Astrophysical Journal*, vol. 797, 21 ([ADS](#))
- 5. Placco, V. M.**, Beers, T. C., Roederer, I., Cowan, J., Frebel, A., Filler, D., Ivans, I. I., Lawler, J. E., Schatz, H., Sneden, C., Sobek, J., Aoki, W., Smith, V. V.
Hubble Space Telescope Near-Ultraviolet Spectroscopy of the Bright CEMP-no Star BD+44° 493
2014, *The Astrophysical Journal*, vol. 790, 34 ([ADS](#))
- 4. Placco, V. M.**, Frebel, A., Beers, T. C., Christlieb, N., Lee, Y. S., Kennedy, C. R., Rossi, S., Santucci, R.
Metal-poor Stars Observed with the Magellan Telescope. II. Discovery of Four Stars with $[Fe/H] \leq -3.5$
2014, *The Astrophysical Journal*, vol. 781, 40 ([ADS](#))
- 3. Placco, V. M.**, Frebel A., Beers T. C., Karakas A., Kennedy C. R., Rossi S., Christlieb N., Stancliffe R.
Metal-Poor Stars Observed with the Magellan Telescope I. Constraints on Progenitor Mass and Metallicity of

AGB Stars Undergoing s-Process Nucleosynthesis

2013, *The Astrophysical Journal*, vol. 770, 104 ([ADS](#))

2. **Placco, V. M.**, Kennedy C.R., Beers T.C., Christlieb N., Rossi S., Sivarani T., Lee Y.S., Reimers D., Wisotzki L.
Searches for Metal-Poor Stars from the Hamburg/ESO Survey using the CH G-band
2011, *The Astronomical Journal*, vol. 142, 188 ([ADS](#))

1. **Placco, V. M.**, Kennedy C.R., Rossi S., Beers T.C., Lee Y.S., Christlieb N., Sivarani T., Reimers D., Wisotzki L.
A Search for Unrecognized Carbon-Enhanced Metal-Poor Stars in the Galaxy
2010, *The Astronomical Journal*, vol. 139, 1051 ([ADS](#))

Second/Third Author (★ for relevant non-refereed publications)

36. Jeong, M., Lee, Y. S., **Placco, V. M.**, Hirai, Y., Beers, T., Heo, J., Chiboucas, K., Deibert, E., Gamen, R., Kalari, V., Martioli, E., Diaz, R., Gomez-Jimenez, M., Ruiz-Carmona, R., Burley, G., Robertson, J. G., Labrie, K., Thomas-Osip, J.
The Actinide-Boost Star LAMOST J122216.85–063345.2: A Detailed R-process Abundance Study with Gemini-S/GHOST
2026, *The Astrophysical Journal*, vol. 1005, 92 ([ADS](#))
35. Mardini, M. K., Frebel, A., **Placco, V. M.**, Chiti, A., MAnolia, Y., Beers, T., Ezzeddine, R., Hansen, T. T., Holmbeck, E. M., Roederer, I. U., Sakari, C. M.
The R-process Alliance: A Bright, Strongly R-process-enhanced Extremely Metal-poor Star Observed with GHOST
2026, *The Astrophysical Journal*, vol. 1005, 20 ([ADS](#))
34. Chiti, A., **Placco, V. M.**, Pace, A., Ji, A., Prabhu, D., Cerny, W., Limberg, G., Stringfellow, G., Drlica-Wagner, A., Atzberger, K., Choi, Y., Crnojević, D., Ferguson, P., Kallivayalil, N., Noël, N., Riley, A., Sand, D., Simon, J., Walker, A., Bom, C., Carballo-Bello, J., James, D., Martínez-Vázquez, C., Medina, G., Vivas, K.
A second-generation star in a relic dwarf galaxy
2026, *Nature Astronomy*, vol. 10, 830 ([ADS](#))
33. Zhang, Z., Ji, A. P., **Placco, V. M.**, Curtis, S.
Quantifying Element Importance for Mass Recovery from Population III Supernova Yield Fits
2026, *The Astrophysical Journal*, vol. 1004, 252 ([ADS](#))
32. Machado-Pereira, E., Daflon, S., **Placco, V. M.**, Cruz, P., Borges Fernandes, M., Jiménez-Esteban, F., Caballero, J. A., Anguiano, B., Yuan, H., Bonatto, C., Alvarez-Candal, A., Cenarro, J., Cristóbal-Hornillos, D., Hernández-Monteagudo, C., López-Sanjuan, C., Marín-Franch, A., Moles, M., Varela, J., Vázquez Ramió, H., Alcaniz, J., Dupke, R., Ederoclite, A., Sodr   Jr., L., Angulo, R.
J-PLUS: stellar parameter determination of members of open clusters using machine learning
2026, *Monthly Notices of the Royal Astronomical Society*, vol. 546, 132 ([ADS](#))
31. Roederer, I. U., **Placco, V. M.**, Karakas, A. I., Den Hartog, E. A., Beers, T. C.
Abundances of Rarely Detected s-process Elements Derived from the Ultraviolet Spectrum of the s-process-enhanced Metal-poor Star HD 196944
2025, *The Astrophysical Journal*, vol. 995, 2 ([ADS](#))
30. Limberg, G., **Placco, V. M.**, Ji, A. P., Yao, Y., Chiti, A., Mardini, M. K., Frebel, A., Rossi, S.
Discovery of an $[Fe/H] \sim -4.8$ Star in Gaia XP Spectra
2025, *The Astrophysical Journal Letters*, vol. 989, 18 ([ADS](#))
29. Bandyopadhyay, A., Ezzeddine, R., **Placco, V. M.**, Frebel, A., Aguado, D. S., Roederer, I. U.
Probing Abundance Variations Among Multiple Stellar Populations in the Metal-poor Globular Cluster NGC 2298 Using Gemini-South/GHOST
2025, *The Astronomical Journal*, vol. 170, 37 ([ADS](#))

- ★ Fitzpatrick, M., **Placco, V. M.**, Bolton, A., Merino, B., Ridgway, S., Stanghellini, L.
Modernizing IRAF to Support Gemini Data Reduction
2025, Astronomical Data Analysis Software & Systems XXXIII (ADS)
- 28. Perottoni, H. D., **Placco, V. M.**, Almeida-Fernandes, F., Herpich, F. R., Rossi, S., Beers, T., Smiljanic, R., Amarante, J., Limberg, G., Werle, A., Rocha-Pinto, H., Beraldo e Silva, L., Daflon, S., Alvarez-Candal, A., Schoenell, W., Ribeiro, T., Kanaan, A.
The S-PLUS Ultra-Short Survey: First Data Release
2024, Astronomy & Astrophysics, vol. 691, 138 ([ADS](#))
- 27. Quispe-Huaynasi, F., Roig, F., **Placco, V. M.**, Beraldo e Silva, L., Pereira, C. B., Daflon, S., Kanaan, A., Mendes de Oliveira, C., Ribeiro, T., Schoenell, W.
Characterisation of high velocity stars in the S-PLUS internal fourth data release
2024, Monthly Notices of the Royal Astronomical Society, vol. 527, 6173 ([ADS](#))
- 26. Almeida-Fernandes, F., **Placco, V. M.**, Rocha-Pinto, H. J., Borges Fernandes, M., Limberg, G., Beraldo e Silva, L., Amarante, J., Perottoni, H. D., Overzier, R., Schoenell, W., Ribeiro, T., Kanaan, A., Mendes de Oliveira, C.
Chemodynamical Properties and Ages of Metal-Poor Stars in S-PLUS
2023, Monthly Notices of the Royal Astronomical Society, vol. 523, 2934 ([ADS](#))
- 25. Roederer, I. U., Pace, A., **Placco, V. M.**, Caldwell, N., Koposov, S., Mateo, M., Olszewski, E., Walker, M.
Abundance Analysis of Stars at Large Radius in the Sextans Dwarf Spheroidal Galaxy
2023, The Astrophysical Journal, vol. 954, 55 ([ADS](#))
- 24. Zepeda, J., Beers, T. C., **Placco, V. M.**, Shank, D., Gudin, D., Hirai, Y., Yoon, J., Mardini, M., Pifer, C., Catapano, T., Calagna, S.
Chemo-Dynamically Tagged Groups of CEMP Stars in the Halo of the Milky Way. I. Untangling the Origins of CEMP-s and CEMP-no Stars
2023, The Astrophysical Journal, vol. 947, 23 ([ADS](#))
- 23. Shank, D., Beers, T., **Placco, V. M.**, Gudin, D., Catapano, T., Holmbeck, E. M., Ezzeddine, R., Roederer, I. U., Sakari, C. M., Frebel, A., Hansen, T. T.
The R-Process Alliance: Chemo-Dynamically Tagged Groups II. Extended Sample of Halo r-Process-Enhanced Stars
2023, The Astrophysical Journal, vol. 943, 23 ([ADS](#))
- 22. Arentsen, A., **Placco, V. M.**, Lee, Y. S., Aguado, D. S., Martin, N. F., Starkenburg, E., Yoon, J.
On the inconsistency of $[C/Fe]$ abundances and the fractions of carbon-enhanced metal-poor stars among various stellar surveys
2022, Monthly Notices of the Royal Astronomical Society, vol. 515, 4082 ([ADS](#))
- 21. Shank, D., Beers, T., **Placco, V. M.**, Limberg, G., Jaques, E., Yuan, Zhen, Schlaufman, K. C., Casey, A. R., Huang, Y., Lee, Y. S., Hattori, K., Santucci, R. M.
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